

Discovery Call Script

Prospect: [Name / Company] **Call date:** [Date] **Referral source:** [How they found you] **Consultant:** [Your Name / Business Name]

How to use: This is a guide, not a word-for-word transcript — the questions matter more than the exact phrasing. Fill in your own numbers and examples where noted.

Before the call

- ☐ Look up the prospect's company/site and note anything specific to reference
 - ☐ Know your own numbers cold (day rate, minimum project size) — see the [Freelance Day Rate Calculator]
 - ☐ Have your calendar open in case you need to book a follow-up on the spot
 - ☐ Block 30 minutes — don't run this call in a rushed 15-minute slot
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1. Open (2 minutes)

Hi [Name], thanks for making time. Before we dive in — my goal for this call is just to understand what you're dealing with and whether I'm the right fit to help. If it's not a fit, I'll tell you straight, and if it is, we'll figure out the right next step. Sound good?

2. Diagnose the real problem (8-10 minutes)

- "Walk me through what's prompting this — what's happening (or not happening) that made you start looking?"
- "What have you already tried, and what happened?"
- "If nothing changes, what does this cost you — in time, money, or missed opportunity?"
- "What would 'solved' actually look like six months from now?"

Notes: [Space for notes]

3. Qualify budget, authority, and timeline (8-10 minutes)

Budget

- "Do you have a budget range in mind, even a rough one?"
- **If they won't share a number:** "No worries — can you tell me what this problem is costing you every month it goes unsolved? That helps me size the right solution."

Authority

- "Aside from you, who else is involved in this decision?"
- "What does the approval process usually look like on your end?"

Timeline

- "Is there a date this needs to be solved by, or something driving urgency?"
- "What happens if this slips to next quarter instead?"

Notes: [Space for notes]

4. Close the call (5 minutes)

Choose the path that fits what you heard:

A — Clear fit:

"Based on what you've shared, I think I can help. Here's what I'll do next: I'll put together a proposal and send it over by [date]. Before I do, I'll send a short onboarding questionnaire so I can make sure the proposal reflects exactly what you need."

B — Possible fit, needs more information:

"This sounds like it could be a fit, but I want to make sure I scope it accurately. Can I send over a short questionnaire, and then we grab 15 minutes early next week to confirm before I send a proposal?"

C — Not a fit:

"Based on what you've described, I don't think I'm the right fit for this — [one honest reason]. [If applicable: I'd recommend looking into [alternative type of provider/resource].] I appreciate you taking the time to talk it through."

Post-call scoring

Criteria	Notes	Fit? (Y/N)
Problem is clear and solvable by you		
Budget signal aligns with your rate		
Talking to the actual decision-maker (or a clear path to them)		
Timeline is realistic for your availability		

Next step: [Send proposal / send questionnaire / decline] **By when:** [Date]

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